

# Capturing The Real Process

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*Describe how the work actually happens today, the messy as-is reality, not the clean official version.*

## The Trap

Asked how a process works, people describe how it is supposed to work, the clean version in a policy document or a manager's head. The real process is messier, full of workarounds, informal handoffs, and undocumented steps people invented to get through the week. The gap between the official and the real is usually exactly where your improvement opportunity is hiding.

## Why It Matters

You cannot improve a process you do not truly understand, and most of us think we understand our own far better than we do. Only the people whose hands are on the work know the real steps, waits, and tricks. No tool and no manager three levels up has that knowledge. This phase rewards humility and curiosity, going and asking and watching.

## Where AI Fits

AI is a useful organizer and clarifier. Describe your process in the messy, out-of-order way it lives in your head, and AI will structure it into a clean sequence and ask about the gaps. But AI can only organize what you give it. Feed it the polished version and you just get a tidy version of something untrue.

## Remember this

*Describe what truly happens, not what is supposed to happen.*